✦ TALES OF JUPITER WISDOM • READ & DISCUSS TOGETHER ✦

ZINAIDA JUPITER

THE BAST COTTAGE & THE ICE PALACE

An Illustrated Russian Folk Tale with Guided Family Discussion:
Helping Children & Parents Think Ahead, Build Friendship & Keep Healthy Boundaries



"Both Read, Both Learn: Warm Conversation for the Child & Strategic Insight for the Parent"

Volume IV • Branch A
Collector's Family Edition

COLLECTOR'S FOLIO • 2026

6+

✦ COLLECTOR'S ILLUSTRATED EDITION • ZINAIDA JUPITER ✦

A BOOK FOR SHARED READING & THOUGHTFUL CONVERSATION

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An Illustrated Russian Folk Tale with Guided Discussion for Children & Parents:
Read Together, Think Ahead, Build True Friendship, and Grow Wiser Side by Side

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SERIES “TALES OF JUPITER WISDOM”

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BISAC: JUV012030 / FAM034000 • Collector's Folio **Reading Age: 6+ & Family**

Jupiter, Zinaida (DBA).
The Bast Cottage and the Ice Palace (Zayushkina Izbushka): An Illustrated Russian Folk Tale with Guided Family Discussion & Strategic Thinking Matrix / Retold and designed by Zinaida Jupiter, Doctor of Business Administration (DBA). — 2026. — 12 p. : col. ill. — (Tales of Jupiter Wisdom ; Vol. 4A).

Crafted in the Golden Age tradition of Ivan Bilibin and The Folio Society, this volume brings parent and child together to explore honest craftsmanship versus fragile glamour, healthy personal boundaries, and quiet courage over loud intimidation.

ISBN 978-5-00000-004-8 (EN) • Print Run: 1,000 copies **© Zinaida Jupiter, 2026**

❖ A WORD TO CHILDREN AND PARENTS ❖

Dear Readers! In our age of artificial intelligence, the most precious human gifts are those no machine can ever replace: **critical thinking, looking one step ahead, empathy, loyal friendship, and a clear moral compass of right and wrong**. Most of the painful mistakes we accumulate in youth happen simply because no one taught us in childhood to see tomorrow's consequences behind today's choices.

Centuries of folk wisdom live inside this tale because both child and adult immediately recognize themselves in its mirror. Read it side by side: **Pages 8–9** invite a warm parent–child conversation, while **Pages 10–11** offer a strategic life matrix for parents and growing minds.

With warmth to your family — Zinaida Jupiter,
Doctor of Business Administration (DBA)

THE BAST COTTAGE & THE ICE PALACE

A Classic Russian Folk Tale Retold for Shared Family Reading

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"An ice palace sparkles brighter than any timber cottage in winter, yet only honest work survives the first warm breath of spring…"

Once upon a frosty autumn in the deep Russian woods lived a red Fox and a gentle Hare. As the first silver blizzards whirled through the birches, the two neighbors set out to build their winter homes. The patient Hare worked from dawn till dusk: he felled sturdy timber, wove thick linden-bast bark (*lubok*), tucked warm moss into every seam, and built a snug brick stove. His wooden bast cottage looked modest from outside, yet it stood warm, solid, and true.

The proud Fox had no patience for heavy work. She poured water over a high snowdrift, carved glittering crystal walls, and built herself an Ice Palace. How she laughed at the Hare: "Look at my diamond turret shining in the sun, little Hare, while you live behind plain wooden logs!"



“Whoever begs for an inch of your porch without clear rules often plans to claim your entire hearth…”

Winter passed, and the golden spring sun rose high above the forest clearing. Inside the Hare’s wooden bast cottage it stayed dry and cozy, but the Fox’s glittering Ice Palace began to weep icicles, slumped into slush, and melted away into a babbling brook. Left without a roof in the wet grass, the shivering Fox trotted straight to the Hare’s carved wooden porch.

“Dear neighbor Hare,” she pleaded in her sweetest, silkiest voice, “let me step just onto your porch to dry my frozen paws!” The kind-hearted Hare felt sorry for her and opened his door without setting a single rule. In slipped the Fox—from porch to hallway, from hallway onto the warm brick stove—and before dusk she chased the gentle Hare right out of his own home!



“A bully’s boast sounds terrifying only while the room is dark and no one dares to test the noise…”

Along the woodland path walked the little Hare, wiping away bitter tears with his paws. Up ran a pack of hunting hounds: “Bark-bark-bark! Why are you weeping, little Hare?” — “How could I not weep?” sighed the Hare. “I built a sturdy wooden bast cottage while the Fox built a house of ice. Spring melted her palace, she begged to warm her paws on my porch, and now she has driven me out of my own home!”

“Dry your eyes, Hare, we’ll chase her out at once!” cried the hounds. They marched up to the carved window: “Bark-bark! Come out, Fox!” Out of the dark cottage above the warm stove thundered the Fox’s fierce voice: “Once I leap out, once I spring out, fur and scraps will fly down every forest lane!” Terrified by the roar, the hounds tucked their tails and fled into the woods.



“Broad shoulders and mighty horns avail nothing when the heart lacks resolve to see justice through…”

Again the little Hare sat weeping on a mossy stump. Heavy footsteps shook the pines as a giant brown Bear lumbered by: “Why do you grieve, little Hare?” Hearing the story, the Bear puffed out his chest: “I am the master of the forest—I’ll clear her out in one roar!” He strode to the porch: “Out with you, Fox!” Yet when the Fox snarled from the dark stove —“Once I leap out, fur and scraps will fly!”—even the mighty Bear shrank back and hurried away.

Soon a powerful Bull with curving horns offered his strength as well. He bellowed before the gate, but at the first echoing threat from the shadowy doorway, the Bull too backed down in alarm. The poor Hare’s heart sank: could loud deceit truly be stronger than honest right?



“Before a fearless voice and real resolve, every hollow threat crumbles like spring ice…”

Down the sunlit road marched a gallant golden Rooster in red Moroccan-leather boots, wearing an embroidered kaftan coat and carrying a gleaming silver scythe upon his shoulder. Seeing the Hare in tears, he declared: “Take heart, my friend! The hounds, the Bear, and the Bull only made noise outside the door—I will walk straight inside!”

Stamping his red boot upon the porch, the Rooster rang out: “Cock-a-doodle-doo! In red boots I stride, with a sharp scythe at my side—come down from that stove, Fox, or out you go!” Trembling with panic, the Fox cried: “Wait, I’m putting on my fur coat!” The Rooster did not wait—he stepped straight across the threshold: “Cock-a-doodle-doo!” Out the window bolted the Fox into the deep woods, never to return, while the Hare and the brave Rooster shared warm tea in peace!

READ TOGETHER • REFLECT TOGETHER

The Secret of the Two Houses and the Brave Rooster

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The Heart of the Tale: The Fox's ice palace dazzled in winter but vanished in spring. And the Hare's kind heart suffered because he welcomed a clever guest without clear house rules.

Question I (Real Work vs. Showy Glamour): Why did the Fox build with ice while the Hare worked with timber? Where in school or life is it wiser to build something lasting rather than flashy?

Question II (Kindness with Healthy Boundaries): Was it good of the Hare to pity the cold Fox? How could he have helped her warm up while keeping clear rules in his own home?

Question III (True Courage vs. Loud Size): The Bear and the Bull were huge, while the Rooster was small. Why did the Fox run away from the Rooster?

❖ THE WISE HOST'S GOLDEN RULE ❖

"My door is warm to a friend in need, yet in my home we respect the host and keep our word!"

INTERACTIVE CHOICE FOR CHILD & PARENT

Three Paths: What If Someone Pushes Your Boundaries?

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Path A (The Timid Hare): Stay silent, give away your space to anyone who shouts loudly, and cry alone on a stump.

Path B (The Boastful Bear): Talk big at the gate, but back down the moment a task feels uncomfortable.

★ **Path C (The Wise Hare & Brave Rooster — Our Choice!):** Keep a kind heart, state clear rules from the very start, never fear hollow boasts, and stand firm with loyal friends!

❖ *Creative Space: Draw the Hare's warm wooden cottage and the brave Rooster, or design your own "Family House Shield"!*

- ❖ **Rule 1 (Build to Last):** Choose honest effort and real knowledge that will never melt when seasons change.
- ❖ **Rule 2 (Kindness with Boundaries):** True kindness knows how to say a calm, firm "Stop!" when rules are broken.

BOTH READ, BOTH LEARN • STRATEGIC INSIGHT FOR FAMILY & LIFE

The "Sturdy Home & Clear Boundaries" 2×2 Matrix

Why do hardworking, generous people ("Hares") so often lose ground to loud opportunists ("Foxes")? The answer lies at the intersection of **Foundational Resilience (Y-Axis)** and **Boundary Protection (X-Axis)**.

THE COTTAGE MATRIX (Y-AXIS: FOUNDATION STRENGTH × X-AXIS: BOUNDARY CLARITY)

LOW • Y-AXIS: FOUNDATIONAL RESILIENCE • HIGH ↑

Quadrant 2 (Strong Foundation + Weak Boundaries)

2. "The Unprotected Hare"

Builds real value through honest work, yet hesitates to set rules upfront—allowing aggressive guests to take over the hearth.

★ THE WISE CHOICE (TOP-RIGHT CORNER)

Quadrant 4 (Strong Foundation + Firm Boundaries)

4. "The Protected Hearth"

Enduring craftsmanship and generosity protected by clear agreements on the porch and the Rooster's fearless resolve.

Quadrant 1 (Fragile Foundation + Weak Boundaries)

1. "Melting Spring Ice"

Chasing quick appearances without deep skill or preparation. At the first warm shift of circumstances, the roof vanishes.

Quadrant 3 (Fragile Foundation + Loud Bluff)

3. "The Fox on Another's Stove"

Compensating for a melted foundation by occupying someone else's work and ruling through loud intimidation.

◄ Low (Compliance)X-AXIS: BOUNDARY CLARITY & FIRM RULESHigh (Clear Resolve) ►

❖ How to Read All 4 Quadrants Together as a Family:

- **Quadrants 1 & 3 (The Fox's Trap):** Shortcut glamour always melts under real-world pressure, and loud threats collapse the moment they meet calm courage.
- **Quadrant 2 (The Hare's Blind Spot):** Goodness without clear boundaries invites encroachment. Never let politeness stop you from stating the rules at the door.
- **★ Quadrant 4 (Top-Right — The Family Standard):** Build timber-solid skills and protect your family's peace with clear agreements and decisive action.

TURNING FOLK WISDOM INTO EVERYDAY FAMILY STRENGTH

Three Steps into Quadrant 4 ("The Protected Hearth")

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Step 1. Test "Timber vs. Ice" Early: Teach children to ask before any choice: "Is this glittering ice that will melt next month, or sturdy timber that will serve us for years?"

Step 2. Set the "Porch Agreement" Upfront: Whenever we help friends, classmates, or partners, we state clear terms at the threshold—duration, mutual respect, and boundaries.

Step 3. Call the Bluff Calmly: Loud bullies ("fur and scraps will fly!") rely on darkness and hesitation. Like the Rooster, step forward with calm facts and firm consequences.

Everyday Life & Family Scenario	Quadrant 2: The Soft Hare's Mistake	★ Quadrant 4: The Wise Boundary Response
A classmate asks to copy homework or let you do all the group work	Silently doing everything yourself and feeling resentful afterward.	"I'm happy to explain how it works, and then each of us will write our own part fairly."
An acquaintance or relative asks to borrow a major resource "for a while"	Saying yes with no date or rules because it feels awkward to ask.	"We're glad to help through Friday evening—let's agree on the exact return time right now."
Someone uses a loud voice or threats to push past fair rules	Backing away like the Bear to avoid an uncomfortable scene.	Stepping forward calmly like the Rooster: "Raised voices don't change the rule. Here is what we will do."

❖ **Family Reflection: What "timber skill" or boundary will we strengthen together this week?**

❖ **Family Principle:** A warm heart welcomes friends; a clear mind and firm boundaries protect the home.

BOOK IV SUMMARY (BOTH READ — BOTH LEARN)

Two Golden Keys of "The Bast Cottage & The Ice Palace"

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Sharing this classic tale together leaves both child and parent with a lasting compass:

❖ Key for the Child (6+)

1. Build with Timber, Not Ice: Honest study and patient effort never melt away when challenges arrive.

2. Be Kind Yet Brave Like the Rooster: Help others gladly, but never let loud boasting push you out of what is right.

★ Key for the Parent

1. Anchor in Quadrant 4: Pair enduring substance with clear agreements spoken right on the porch.

2. Resolve Beats Size: Where hesitant "Bears" retreat before noise, calm and decisive action restores order.

COLLECTOR'S ILLUSTRATED FAMILY EDITION • GUIDED READING FOR CHILDREN & PARENTS (6+)

Series **"Tales of Jupiter Wisdom"** • Volume IV (Branch A — Family Edition)
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THE BAST COTTAGE & THE ICE PALACE

Reading Category: Ages 6+ & Family
Typeface: Classical Serif Georgia
Binding Standard: Hardcover, 3D Gold Embossing
Trim Format: 6 × 9 in (170 × 240 mm)
Interior Extent: 12 pages (divisible by 4)
Print Run: 1,000 copies • Edition 2026/04A

First Collector's Printing • 2026
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